Keeno Smith

Cloud Software Engineer | Cloud-Native Applications and Reliability

Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · DevOps · Distributed Systems · Observability

Cape Town · Johannesburg

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Professional Summary

Cloud Software Engineer specialising in cloud-native application development, platform integration and dependable distributed systems. Combine Python, JavaScript/TypeScript and Go engineering with Azure, AWS and Google Cloud services, containerised applications, REST APIs, asynchronous processing and CI/CD to build maintainable software across cloud and local environments.

Experience spans independent software delivery, AI training and evaluation, and business technology consulting. Design the services around cloud applications: persistent data, authentication, messaging, webhooks, monitoring and recovery. Apply structured error handling, retries, access controls, reproducible tests and operational visibility, with attention to dependable service integration, clear technical boundaries and operational readiness.

Technical Skills

AI engineering: AI agents, multi-agent orchestration, tool calling, RAG, embeddings, vector search, prompt and context engineering, structured outputs, LLM integration, evaluation, human review

Programming and services: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, FastAPI, Node.js, Express, REST APIs, OpenAPI, React

Automation and integration: n8n, webhooks, API integration, workflow orchestration, asynchronous processing, event-driven architecture, MCP

AI platforms: Microsoft Foundry, Azure OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, Amazon Bedrock, Gemini, Vertex AI, Ollama, Hugging Face

Reliability and delivery: Exception handling, retries and backoff, logging, monitoring, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Data and security: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Prisma, Mongoose, Redis, IAM, RBAC, least privilege, authentication and authorisation, Azure, AWS, Google Cloud

Experience

Python and Full Stack Engineer in AI Training and Evaluation

Turing / OpenTrain AI | February 2026 – Present

Contribute Python and JavaScript/TypeScript engineering to AI training and evaluation workflows focused on coding ability, reasoning, technical accuracy and response quality.

- Develop, review and evaluate programming solutions for benchmarking and model improvement; assess correctness, maintainability, edge cases and reproducibility.
- Conduct model evaluations and rank responses against defined criteria, documenting technical rationales, reasoning gaps and implementation defects.
- Create and refine task-specific examples for Supervised Fine-Tuning (SFT); provide structured feedback for Reinforcement Learning with Human Feedback (RLHF) workflows.
- Review code and documentation for readability, modularity, testing, security and stability across Python, JavaScript/TypeScript and Docker environments.

Experience Continued

Founder | AI Solutions Engineer and Technology Consultant

KAILOR | June 2026 – Present

Developed an AI-enabled technology consultancy using AI-assisted assessment to identify business needs and scope software, automation and integration solutions. Combine hands-on engineering, specialist partners and third-party platforms according to client requirements.

- Map business processes, manual tasks and integration gaps; translate findings into technical recommendations, solution architectures and implementation scopes.
- Design discovery and assessment workflows that distinguish opportunities for AI from needs better addressed through conventional software or workflow automation.
- Define application and integration approaches using LLMs, APIs, webhooks, structured business rules, workflow orchestration and human review.
- Plan permissions, exception handling, reliability controls and operational safeguards; explain technical limitations and delivery priorities in business terms.

Selected Confidential Client Work

AI and automation engagement: Designed an AI-assisted approach to repetitive administration, customer enquiries and follow-up activities. Mapped the workflow and combined LLM processing, business rules, APIs and orchestration, retaining review for exceptions and higher-risk actions. Client details withheld.

AI application engineering engagement: Designed and developed an AI-enabled application for business information and recurring operational tasks. Engineered structured model interactions, APIs, data processing, application state and controlled outputs within an end-to-end workflow. Client details withheld.

Business process and AI assessment: Assessed manual activities, digital tools and integration gaps. Produced implementation recommendations covering AI, conventional software and third-party automation, with priorities for architecture, human oversight and operational risk. Client details withheld.

Technical and Digital Operations Lead and Co Founder

Firstdaes Entertainment | January 2020 – June 2026

Co-founded an events and entertainment business, owning digital platforms, business systems, workflow design and technology-enabled operational improvements.

- Translated business objectives into requirements, digital solutions and practical process improvements; managed implementation, testing and troubleshooting.
- Evaluated and integrated services for communications, marketing and analytics; coordinated external providers, resources and delivery dependencies.
- Used operational feedback and performance data to improve digital initiatives and maintain the company's technical environment.

Contract Specialist in Technical Content and Documentation

3Play Media | February 2021 – September 2025

- Reviewed, transcribed and edited complex technical material covering software, cloud infrastructure, networking and cybersecurity, preserving terminology and contextual accuracy.
- Resolved ambiguity and inconsistencies; independently managed quality and deadlines across specialist assignments.
- Worked with material associated with enterprise technology organisations including Cisco, Oracle, Palo Alto Networks, Salesforce, NVIDIA and Apple.

Education

Stellenbosch University: Generative AI Mini Bootcamp | June - September 2026

HyperionDev: Full-Stack Software Engineering and Web Development | January - June 2026

University of South Africa: BSc Computer Science studies | 2017 – 2022 GPA 3.75

Selected Projects

Independent portfolio projects demonstrating cloud-native applications, service reliability and operational engineering.

Microsoft Azure DevOps Software Engineering Platform

Azure · Microsoft Foundry · React / TypeScript · Express · FastAPI · MongoDB · Docker

Developed a full-stack engineering operations system connecting GitHub evidence with Azure activity, metrics and incident workflows. Separates React, Express and FastAPI services, persists investigations and audit history, and supports authenticated signals, scoped diagnostics, approvals and recovery verification. Demonstrates cloud-service integration and controlled operational workflows; production deployment was not claimed.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/microsoft-ai-powered-software-engineering-devops

Distributed Systems Reliability Chaos Engineering and Disaster Recovery Platform

Go · React / TypeScript · Docker · Kubernetes · k6 · Toxiproxy · OpenTelemetry

Built a reliability-focused operations platform for testing service behaviour under controlled failure. Combines load generation, fault injection, telemetry and recovery validation across distributed components. Demonstrates retries, idempotency, data-consistency checks and observable operational behaviour relevant to cloud-native and container-based applications.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/sre-chaos-engineering

n8n Enterprise Workflow and Integration OpsFlow Platform

n8n · React / TypeScript · NestJS · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · Redis · Docker

Engineered event-driven procurement workflows covering budget checks, supplier quotations, approval and purchase orders. Integrates an application-owned data and permission model with external orchestration, webhooks, messaging and operational audit trails. Addresses asynchronous delivery, retry behaviour, approval pauses and failure handling across service boundaries.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/n8n-workflow-integration-opsflow

Intelligent Manufacturing Quality Control Platform

Google Cloud-ready · Firestore · Cloud Storage · Rust / Axum · ONNX Runtime · CI/CD

Developed a React and Rust inspection application with Firestore-backed evidence, versioned model releases and storage adapters for local and Google Cloud environments. Includes model activation, rollback, monitoring and a manual cloud deployment workflow. Google Cloud deployment was prepared but not exercised; the implemented inspection and review workflows were verified locally.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/intelligent-manufacturing-qc

Enterprise AI Customer Operations Platform

React · Express · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · Azure Service Bus SDK · Docker · CI/CD

Built a full-stack case operations system with an independent worker, transactional outbox and durable asynchronous jobs. Implements acknowledgement, retries, dead-letter handling, lease recovery, idempotent outcomes and operational health views. Local RabbitMQ processing was verified; Azure Service Bus remained an optional contract-tested integration rather than a claimed live deployment.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/enterprise-ai-customer-operations

Selected Credentials and Professional Development

Microsoft AI-103: Azure AI Apps and Agents Developer Associate certification preparation - In progress

Automation and cloud: n8n Workflow Automation and AI; Google Cloud Manage Kubernetes in Google Cloud; Microsoft Applied Skills in Defender XDR

AI development: Microsoft × Founderz Agent Architect and Cybersecurity training; AWS × Udacity AI/ML Scholars AI Practitioner; AI Programmer Nanodegree; WeThinkCode_ Generative AI for Software Engineers and AI Course for Developers